



A Family Guide to

Advanced Pre-Planning

Helping families plan ahead with clarity and confidence.

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HONOR / CELEBRATE / REMEMBER

SECTION 1

Why Pre-Plan?

When a loved one passes, families face dozens of important decisions — often within the first 48 to 72 hours, while navigating grief. Pre-planning removes that burden before it ever arrives. It is not about dwelling on loss; it is a practical step many families find brings genuine peace of mind.

Bonney Watson has served Seattle-area families since 1861. In that time, we have seen firsthand the difference a pre-plan makes — for the person who passes, and for the family left behind.

“Is this what they would have wanted?” Pre-planning helps ensure your family already knows the answers.

EASE THE BURDEN ON LOVED ONES

Your family faces dozens of decisions in the days after a loss. Pre-planning removes that pressure so they can focus on healing and being together — not logistics.

UNDERSTAND THE COSTS

Funeral and cemetery costs vary. Pre-planning gives you time to review options and costs carefully, without the time pressure of an immediate need.

ENSURE YOUR WISHES ARE HONORED

From the type of service to every personal detail, pre-planning gives you complete control. Your wishes are recorded, respected, and carried out exactly as intended.

At a Glance: With vs. Without Pre-Planning

WITHOUT PRE-PLANNING	WITH BONNEY WATSON
✗ Grief with no roadmap	✓ Wishes clearly documented
✗ Rushed, emotional decisions	✓ Thoughtful, pressure-free choices
✗ Risk of overspending	✓ Price-guaranteed arrangements
✗ Family conflict over choices	✓ Family united by a clear plan
✗ No payment flexibility	✓ Flexible payment & insurance options
✗ Financial burden on the estate	✓ Expenses handled in advance

Did You Know?

70–75

decisions are made within the first 48–72 hours of a death

Only 25%

of Americans have a documented funeral plan in place

\$7K–\$12K

average cost of a traditional funeral arranged at the time of need

SECTION 2

The Reality: Dozens of Decisions in Days

When death occurs, a long list of decisions must be made quickly by the people you love — often while they are still in shock. Without a pre-plan in place, here is what your family will face:

VITAL STATS	CEMETERY	FUNERAL	SERVICE
✓ Full legal name	✓ Interment space	✓ Casket selection	✓ Music & officiant
✓ Social Security #	✓ Endowment care	✓ Embalming & prep	✓ Open/closed casket
✓ Date & place of birth	✓ Burial container	✓ Cosmetology & hair	✓ Clothing selection
✓ Veteran's serial #	✓ Opening & closing	✓ Memorial record	✓ Select pallbearers
✓ Occupation	✓ Memorial marker	✓ Acknowledgment cards	✓ Graveside service
✓ Marital status	✓ Inscription	✓ Flowers	✓ Reception

All of these decisions can be addressed before the time of need.

Our staff can walk you through each item at whatever pace works for you. Having plans in place means your family can focus on each other rather than on logistics when the time comes.

Common Questions About Pre-Planning

Does pre-planning mean I have to pay now?

No. Pre-planning and pre-paying are separate. You can document all your wishes without any upfront payment. Payment options — a lump sum, a payment plan, or insurance — can be arranged separately at any time.

What if I change my mind later?

Plans can be updated any time. Life changes, and your pre-plan can change with it. There is no obligation once your wishes are documented.

Is pre-planning only for older adults?

Not at all. Many people in their 40s and 50s pre-plan after seeing firsthand how much a clear plan helps family members left behind.

Documents to Have on Hand

When you meet with us to begin your plan, it helps to have the following information available. You do not need everything at once — we can work with what you have and fill in the rest over time.

Personal Information

- Full legal name and any former names
- Date and place of birth
- Social Security number
- Father's full name; mother's maiden name

Supporting Documents

- Valid government-issued photo ID
- Military discharge papers (DD-214) if applicable
- Life insurance policy numbers and contacts
- Contact information for next of kin

SECTION 3

How Pre-Planning Works: 3 Simple Steps

Pre-planning is easier than most people expect. Our specialists walk alongside you, explain every option clearly, and ensure your plan reflects exactly what you want.

Gather Your Vital Information

1

We collect everything needed: full legal name, date and place of birth, Social Security number, veteran's information, family details, and employment history. This eliminates guesswork for your family at the most difficult time.

Select Your Cemetery & Memorial Arrangements

2

Choose your interment space — ground burial at Washington Memorial Park, a columbarium niche in the Lakeside Cremation Garden, or another preference. Select your burial container, memorial marker, and endowment care. All choices are recorded securely.

Plan Your Celebration of Life

3

Work with our funeral directors to personalize your service: ceremony type, music, readings, viewing preferences, and every detail that reflects who you are. You can also review casket and urn options at this stage, with prices documented as part of your plan.

Pre-Payment Options

Pre-payment is optional. For those who choose to pay in advance, options include a single lump-sum payment or a payment plan spread over an agreed period. Insurance-funded arrangements are also available. Our staff can walk you through what each option involves.

SECTION 4

Cremation Services & Plans

Choosing cremation is a deeply personal decision, and there is no single right answer. Each plan below includes the professional services of our funeral directors, the transfer of your loved one to our care, and the cremation itself. You can add a viewing, a formal ceremony, or choose a quiet direct cremation.

VIEWING & FUNERAL PLAN (CREMATION)	From \$6,725
Basic services of funeral director & staff	\$2,425.00
Embalming	\$945.00
Other preparation (incl. hair dressing)	\$375.00
Use of facilities/staff — viewing, Sun–Thu up to 3 hrs	\$515.00
Use of equipment/staff — ceremony	\$965.00
Cremation & processing	\$385.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home	\$715.00
Simply Treasured Memorial Package	\$310.00
Flower allowance	\$350.00
Urn allowance	\$325.00
<i>Service Savings</i>	<i>(\$585.00)</i>
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS	\$6,725.00

Fri/Sat ceremony fees not included. Cremation container required from Bonney Watson. No deletions. Sales tax on merchandise.

MEMORIAL SERVICE CREMATION PLAN	From \$4,995
Basic services of funeral director & staff	\$2,425.00
Use of equipment/staff — ceremony	\$965.00
Cremation & processing	\$385.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home	\$715.00
Simply Treasured Memorial Package	\$310.00
Flower allowance	\$300.00
Urn allowance	\$325.00
<i>Service Savings</i>	<i>(\$430.00)</i>
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS	\$4,995.00

No embalming or viewing included. Ideal for families wanting a ceremony without a prior viewing.

BASIC CREMATION WITH IDENTIFICATION VIEWING		From \$4,040
Basic services of funeral director & staff		\$2,425.00
Limited preparation for un-embalmed remains		\$535.00
Cremation & processing		\$385.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home		\$715.00
Urn allowance		\$325.00
<i>Service Savings</i>		<i>(\$345.00)</i>
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS		\$4,040.00

Brief ID viewing for immediate family only. No ceremony or embalming.

Direct Cremation Options

Option	Price
Alternative container provided by purchaser	\$3,055
With Trayview Alternative Container	\$3,535
With Standard Brown Alternative Container	\$3,935
With container selected from Bonney Watson (excludes container cost)	\$3,055+

Direct cremation starts at \$3,055 and is the most affordable option. All plans include transfer of the deceased, basic services of funeral director and staff, and cremation & processing. Cremated remains can be mailed within the continental U.S. for \$205.

Additional Cremation Services

Service	Price
Mailing of cremated remains (continental U.S.)	\$205
Delivery of cremated remains to local facility	\$255
Family to witness cremation	\$445
Expedited cremation (within 72 hrs of paperwork)	\$565
Other preparation prior to cremation	\$375
Storage removal after 90 days	\$625
Transfer to keepsakes (up to 4 incl.)	\$10 each add'l

SECTION 5

Burial & Entombment Services

These funeral service plans cover the professional and logistical elements of burial or entombment. You are not required to use our cemetery — we work with families who have chosen any cemetery. The funeral service costs below apply regardless of where interment takes place.

Each plan includes the professional services of our funeral directors, transfer of your loved one to our care, and use of a hearse. Transportation is included within a 30-mile radius; additional mileage is charged at \$3.75/mile.

VIEWING & FUNERAL PLAN (BURIAL)	From \$7,220
Basic services of funeral director & staff	\$2,425.00
Embalming	\$945.00
Other preparation (incl. hair dressing)	\$375.00
Facilities/staff — viewing, Sun–Thu up to 3 hrs	\$515.00
Equipment/staff — ceremony	\$965.00
Graveside service (local cemetery, 30-mi radius)	\$425.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home	\$715.00
Use of hearse	\$705.00
Use of utility vehicle	\$205.00
Simply Treasured Memorial Package	\$310.00
Flower allowance	\$350.00
<i>Service Savings</i>	<i>(–\$715.00)</i>
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS	\$7,220.00

Casket must be purchased from Bonney Watson. Fri/Sat fees not included. No deletions.

GRAVESIDE SERVICE PLAN		From \$4,900
Basic services of funeral director & staff		\$2,425.00
Other preparation of deceased		\$375.00
Graveside service within 30-mile radius		\$655.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home		\$715.00
Use of hearse		\$705.00
Use of utility vehicle		\$205.00
Flower allowance		\$300.00
Service Savings		(-\$480.00)
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS		\$4,900.00

Intimate, dignified farewell at the graveside. Fri/Sat/holiday fees not included.

BASIC BURIAL WITH IDENTIFICATION VIEWING		From \$4,075
Basic services of funeral director & staff		\$2,425.00
Limited preparation of un-embalmed remains		\$535.00
Transfer of deceased to funeral home		\$715.00
Hearse to cemetery within 30-mile radius		\$705.00
Service Savings		(-\$305.00)
PLAN PRICE WITH SAVINGS		\$4,075.00

Simple, respectful burial without extended viewing or formal ceremony.

A Note on Cemetery & Interment Options

The funeral service plans above do not include a burial space. You may use any cemetery of your choice. If you are interested in interment at Washington Memorial Park, we offer a range of options including ground burial, mausoleum entombment, columbarium niches, cremation gardens, and scattering. Please reach out to your Advance Planning Specialist for availability and pricing on cemetery spaces.

SECTION 6

Caskets & Urns: What to Know

Bonney Watson offers a wide range of caskets and urns at various price points. The selections below represent a cross-section of what is available. A full price list is provided at arrangement.

Wood Caskets — Suitable for Burial & Cremation

Select Hardwood Solid caskets are crafted entirely from solid hardwood (cherry, walnut, pecan) for the most durable, richly grained option. **Select Hardwoods & Veneers** combine a solid frame with a fine wood veneer exterior — the look of solid wood with excellent value. **Pine Solids & Veneers** offer a lighter, more economical option with natural warmth, suitable for both burial and cremation.



Lynx Brown

\$1,755

Select Hardwoods & Veneers Pecan Stain
· Rosetan Crepe



Forever Honored — Black

\$3,090

Select Hardwood Solid Russet Stain ·
Memory Safe® Drawer



Libra Harvest Brown

\$4,820

Select Hardwoods & Veneers Rich Brown
Stain · Rosetan Crepe

Wood caskets are available from \$1,540 to \$7,281. All models shown are suitable for burial and cremation. A complete price list is available at arrangement.

Metal Caskets — Suitable for Burial

Metal caskets offer exceptional durability and are suitable for ground burial and mausoleum entombment. Our selection spans 18-gauge, 20-gauge, and non-gasketed steel in a wide range of colors and finishes.



Virgo Silver

\$1,470

18-Gauge Steel · Silver Exterior Ivory
Crepe Interior



Antique Blue

\$2,520

20-Gauge Steel · Blue Exterior Light Blue
Crepe · Memorial Record®



Misty Rose

\$4,135

20-Gauge Steel · Pink Exterior Moss Pink
Crepe · Living Memorial®

Metal caskets are available from \$1,470 to \$4,145. A complete price list is available at arrangement.

SECTION 7

Urn Selections

Urn selections are available for ground burial, columbarium niche placement, and scattering. The options below cover a range of materials and price points. Many can be personalized with engraving.



Stone-Tone Catalina

\$250

Cultured Marble · Speckled Grey · Ground Burial



Alpine White Marble

\$395

Cultured Marble · Smooth White Finish · Ground Burial



Nero Marquina Marble

\$295

Natural Marble · Black with White Veining · Niche Placement



Alcove — Burgundy

\$350

Steel · Mauve/Burgundy Finish · Gold Memorial Medallion · Niche Placement



Meadow Green Marble

\$395

Cultured Marble · Green Marbleized Finish · Ground Burial



Silver Steel Chest

\$250

Carbon Steel 20ga · Painted Finish · Engraving Available · Niche Placement

Many more casket and urn selections are available.

The caskets and urns shown in this guide are a sample of what we carry. We offer a wide range of styles, materials, colors, and price points. Urns are available for ground burial (\$250+), niche placement (\$250+), and scattering (\$95+). Please speak with your Advance Planning Specialist or visit bonneywatson.com to explore the full selection.

SECTION 8

Practical Matters: What Families Need to Know

Death Certificates

A death certificate is an official legal document needed to settle accounts, transfer property, claim benefits, and manage personal affairs. Bonney Watson handles the filing on your behalf — no trip to the health department required.

- **Cost in Washington State:** Each certified copy is \$25.00. Pierce County adds a \$4.00 shipping fee plus a \$10.00 review fee.
- **How many do you need?** One per: life insurance, bank accounts, real estate, retirement accounts, military benefits, vehicle titles, and each credit card or utility in the deceased's name.
- **Processing time:** Typically 7–10 business days after filing.
- **Corrections:** WA Dept of Health allows one free exchange, but corrected certificates can take up to 8 weeks. Order more than you think you need — reordering later takes time.

What To Do When Death Occurs

Situation	What to Do
At Home	If your loved one was under hospice care, notify the hospice nurse — they will contact us. Otherwise, call 911.
At a Hospital	Let the hospital know which funeral home you have chosen. They will contact us once their paperwork is complete.
Hospice or Care Facility	Notify staff of your chosen funeral home. They will reach out to us directly.
Out of State or Country	Contact your local Bonney Watson location. We can coordinate transportation with a funeral home at that location.

Reaching Us

Bonney Watson staff are available to assist you at any hour - day or night, weekday or weekend. When you are ready to speak with someone, call 206-277-5417 or visit bonneywatson.com.

Who to Notify After a Death

In the days following a loss, several agencies and institutions will need to be informed. Having this list prepared in advance can spare your family significant time and stress.

Government & Benefits

Social Security Administration — Stop benefit payments; ask about survivor benefits

Veterans Affairs — Notify if veteran; burial and survivor benefits may be available

IRS / Tax Authorities — A final tax return must be filed for the year of death

Financial & Personal Accounts

Life insurance providers — File claims promptly; policies often pay within days

Banks & financial institutions — Freeze or transfer accounts; bring a death certificate

Credit cards & utilities — Close accounts to prevent ongoing charges

Note: Bonney Watson reports the death to the Social Security Administration on your behalf. Certified copies of the death certificate are needed for most notifications above.

SECTION 9

Having the Conversation with Your Family

One of the most common reasons families delay pre-planning is simply not knowing how to bring it up. The conversation is much easier when death is not imminent. Here are approaches our clients have found helpful:

- **Set aside time for it.** A planned conversation tends to go better than one raised without warning. Let your family know you'd like to talk through it at some point.
- **Ease into it.** Simple questions — like where you'd prefer to be buried or what kind of service feels right — can open the conversation without pressure.
- **Use real-life moments.** Attending a service for a friend or family member often makes it easier to talk about preferences — what felt right, what you'd want differently.
- **Keep the focus practical.** The goal is simply to have your wishes documented so your family doesn't have to guess or make decisions under pressure.
- **Involve family if it helps.** Some people prefer to plan privately and share the results; others find it useful to have a family member present during the process.

QUESTIONS WORTH THINKING ABOUT

1. Have you ever talked about final arrangements with your family?
2. Have you helped make arrangements for someone else before?
3. Who would be responsible for these decisions if you died today?
4. Do your loved ones know where to find your important documents?

Ready to learn more or get started?

Reach out to your Advance Planning Specialist:

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